

Word family: **trade / trades / traded / trading / trader**

Base word: trade

Past tense: traded

Past participle: traded

-ing form: trading

Related forms: trader, trading

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “We used to play football in the park, **trade comic books**, and ride our bicycles around the housing estate until sunset.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **trade** means to **exchange one thing for another**, usually because each person gives something and receives something else in return.

The speaker and Ryan used to swap comic books with each other.

繁體中文： **雙方把自己擁有的物品交給對方，並換取對方的物品；交換**

中文翻譯：

> “We used to ... **trade comic books**...”

「我們以前會.....**交換漫畫書**.....」

Here:

trade comic books = 互相把自己的漫畫書拿出來交換

1. **trade + goods/items (物品) — 交換；互換**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To give one thing and receive another thing in return.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We used to **trade comic books**.”

「我們以前會互相**交換漫畫書**。」

Practice 2

> “The children **traded** cards during recess.”

「孩子們在小息時互相**交換卡片**。」

Practice 3

> “I **traded** my old game for a newer one.”

「我把舊遊戲**換成**了一款較新的。」

trade something = 把自己擁有的東西交給別人，同時換取另一樣東西

Common:

- * trade cards
- * trade books
- * trade clothes
- * trade one thing for another

These belong to one **exchange** sense.

2. **trade** = buy and sell goods/services (商業) — 買賣；交易

This is a major business meaning.

Meaning: To buy and sell goods, services, shares, currencies, etc., especially as a regular business activity.

Practice 4

> “The company **trades** in electronic equipment.”

「這家公司從事電子設備的**買賣 / 交易**。」

Practice 5

> “They **trade** with companies across Asia.”

「他們與亞洲各地的公司進行**貿易 / 交易**。」

trade = 以商業方式買入和賣出商品、服務或其他資產

This is genuinely different from two children swapping comics.

3. **trade = exchange financial assets (金融) — 買賣 ; 交易**

In finance, **trade** means buying and selling shares, currencies, commodities, securities, etc.

Practice 6

> “She **trades** shares online.”

「她在網上**買賣股票**。」

Practice 7

> “The currency is actively **traded** on international markets.”

「這種貨幣在國際市場上被大量**交易**。」

trade financial assets = 在金融市場上買入和賣出股票、貨幣、商品或其他金融資產

For database counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 under the broader commercial **buy-and-sell** concept, while keeping it explicit as a useful financial subtype.

4. **trade = exchange one thing for another figuratively (非實體交換) — 以.....換取.....**

Trade can also be figurative.

Practice 8

> “She traded security for independence.”

「她以安全感**換取**了獨立。」

Practice 9

> “He traded a high salary for more free time.”

「他放棄高薪，**換取**更多自由時間。」

trade A for B = 放棄或交出一樣東西，以換取另一樣東西

This is related to Meaning 1, but the exchanged things can be abstract:

- * time
- * comfort
- * freedom
- * money
- * status

For core counting, I would normally merge this with the broad **exchange** sense.

5. **trade** = exchange positions/roles (位置 / 角色) — 互換 ; 交換位置

Practice 10

> “Can we **trade seats**?”

「我們可以**交換座位**嗎？」

Practice 11

> “The two players **traded positions**.”

「兩名球員**交換了位置**。」

trade positions/seats = 彼此交換原本所佔的位置或角色

Again, this is still the broader **exchange one thing for another** concept.

6. **trade** = profession/skilled occupation (職業) — 手藝 ; 行業 ; 技工職業

As a noun, **trade** can mean a skilled manual occupation or practical profession.

Practice 12

> “Carpentry is a skilled **trade**.”

「木工是一門專業**手藝 / 技工職業**。」

Practice 13

> “He learned a **trade** after leaving school.”

「他離校後學了一門**手藝 / 技術職業**。」

****a trade = 需要專門實務技能、通常經過訓練或學徒制度學習的職業****

Common:

- * skilled trade
- * building trade
- * learn a trade

This is a genuinely different noun meaning.

7. ****trade = business/industry sector (行業) — 行業 ; 業界****

****Trade**** can refer to people and businesses involved in a particular kind of commercial activity.

Practice 14

> “She works in the travel ****trade****.”

「她在旅遊****業界 / 行業****工作。」

Practice 15

> “The book is well known within the publishing ****trade****.”

「這本書在出版****業界****很有名。」

****the trade = 從事某一類商業活動的人、公司及整個行業****

This is related to commercial trade, but the referent shifts from:

> the activity of buying/selling

to:

> the industry/community involved in it

For learners, that is distinct enough to show separately.

8. ****trade = commerce between countries/regions (國際貿易) — 貿易****

As a noun, **trade** can mean the broader system or volume of buying and selling between countries or regions.

Practice 16

> “International **trade** has increased significantly.”

「國際**貿易**大幅增加。」

Practice 17

> “The port depends heavily on overseas **trade**.”

「這個港口非常依賴海外**貿易**。」

trade = 國家、地區或大型市場之間商品和服務的買賣活動

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 as the noun form of commercial buying and selling.

9. **trade** = one completed transaction (交易) — 一筆交易

In finance and business, **a trade** can mean one particular purchase/sale transaction.

Practice 18

> “He made three **trades** this morning.”

「他今天早上做了三筆**交易**。」

Practice 19

> “The **trade** was completed within seconds.”

「那筆**交易**在幾秒內完成。」

a trade = 一次具體的買入、賣出或交換交易

This is closely related to the broader commercial activity and would usually stay under the same core meaning.

10. **trade** = sports transfer/exchange of players (體育) — 交易球員；轉會交換

In some sports, especially North American team sports, **trade** means transferring players between teams, often in exchange for other players or draft picks.

Practice 20

> “The team **traded** its star player.”

「球隊把明星球員**交易**到另一隊。」

Practice 21

> “The two clubs agreed to a major **trade**.”

「兩支球隊同意進行一宗大型**球員交易**。」

trade a player / a trade = 球隊之間交換或轉移球員及相關資產

This is a domain-specific extension of the exchange meaning.

Under the Golden Manual, I would show it but usually merge it semantically into the broader **exchange** concept.

Related form: **trading**

Trading means the activity of buying and selling.

Practice 22

> “Online **trading** has become very common.”

「網上**交易**已變得非常普遍。」

Practice 23

> “The company suspended **trading** for the day.”

「公司當天暫停了**交易活動**。」

trading = 持續或有組織地進行買賣的活動

Related form: **trader**

A **trader** is a person or company that buys and sells goods or financial assets.

Practice 24

> “He works as a currency **trader**.”

「他是一名外匯**交易員**。」

Practice 25

> “Local **traders** sell fruit and vegetables in the market.”

「本地**商販** / 商人**在市場售賣水果和蔬菜**。」

trader = 以買賣商品、貨幣、股票等作為工作或業務的人 / 公司

The Chinese changes naturally by context:

* finance → 交易員

* market/business → 商人 / 商販

Important distinction: **trade** vs **exchange**

This is especially relevant because you already curated **exchange**.

trade

often suggests:

- * reciprocal swapping;
- * commercial buying and selling;
- * business/market activity.

exchange

is broader in some non-commercial contexts:

- * exchange greetings
- * exchange ideas
- * exchange information
- * exchange currency

Compare:

> “We traded comic books.”

= 我們互換漫畫書。

> “We exchanged greetings.”

= 我們互相打招呼。

You would not normally say:

> “We traded greetings.” ❌

So **trade** has a stronger idea of **giving one thing for another**, especially goods/assets.

Important distinction: **trade vs sell**

sell

focuses on giving something to a buyer in exchange for money.

trade

can involve:

- * buying and selling generally;
- * swapping one thing directly for another.

> “I sold my bike for \$200.”

= 收到金錢。

> “I traded my bike for a laptop.”

= 直接以物換物。

Different transaction structure.

Important distinction: **trade vs swap**

swap

is usually informal and strongly emphasizes direct exchange.

> “We swapped seats.”

trade

can also mean direct exchange but has much broader commercial and professional meanings.

> trade goods

> international trade

> stock trading

So **swap** is narrower and more conversational.

Important distinction: **trade vs business**

business

is extremely broad and can refer to:

* a company;

* commercial activity;

* work matters.

trade

more specifically involves:

* buying/selling;

* commerce;

* or a skilled occupation.

> “international trade”

more precise than:

> “international business”

if the subject is cross-border buying and selling.

Important distinction: **trade vs profession**

profession

often refers to an occupation requiring advanced education or formal qualification.

trade

traditionally refers more to skilled practical/manual occupations.

Examples:

- * electrician → trade
- * plumber → trade
- * lawyer → profession

Modern boundaries can blur, but this remains a useful learner distinction.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **trade**
- * **trades**
- * **traded**
- * **trading**
- * **trader**

Useful compounds and expressions include:

- * international trade
- * foreign trade
- * trade agreement
- * trade route
- * trade fair
- * skilled trade
- * stock trading
- * trade one thing for another

The Golden Manual says common business, finance, and domain-specific uses should be checked while uses sharing the same underlying exchange/commercial concept should still be merged conservatively.

Master comparison

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trade — exchange one thing for another	把自己擁有的東西交給別人，同時換取另一樣東西
trade — buy and sell commercially	以商業方式買入和賣出商品、服務、金融資產等
trade A for B — figurative exchange	放棄、交出或犧牲某樣東西，以換取另一種利益、狀態或結果；屬於 exchange 義
a trade — skilled occupation	需要專門實務技能、通常透過培訓或學徒制度掌握的技工職業 / 手藝
the trade — industry/community	從事某一類商業活動的人、公司及整個業界
trade — international commerce	國家或地區之間買賣商品和服務的商業活動；屬於 commercial trade 義
a trade — transaction	一次具體的買入、賣出或交換交易
trading	持續或有組織地進行買賣的活動
trader	以買賣商品、股票、貨幣等作為工作或業務的人 / 公司

For your original sentence

> “We used to ... ****trade comic books****...”

The exact meaning is:

****trade = 把自己擁有的物品交給對方，同時換取對方的物品****

So:

> ****trade comic books****

= ****互相交換漫畫書****

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely distinct core meanings**** for ****trade****:

1. ****exchange one thing for another****
2. ****commercial buying and selling / commerce****
3. ****a skilled occupation or craft****
4. ****the trade — a particular business/industry community****

I would merge ****international trade, financial trading, individual trades****, and ****sports player trades**** into #1 or #2 depending on context rather than inflate the core count.